

Conclusions - Workbook 1

Synthesize patterns across several details.

Strategy reminder

Combine several details, then control scope. The best conclusion is broad enough to explain the pattern but narrow enough to remain supported.

Reusable Cup Trial

Text 1

A cafe tested reusable cups for six weeks. Customers who brought a cup received a small discount. Reusable-cup use rose from 12 percent of drink orders to 31 percent. Disposable-cup waste fell, but staff spent more time washing returned cafe-owned cups. The manager decided to keep the discount while testing a faster washing system.

1. Which conclusion is best supported?

- A. The trial reduced disposable-cup use but also created a new operating challenge
- B. Reusable cups eliminated all waste
- C. Every customer preferred reusable cups
- D. The discount had no effect

2. Which statement is too broad?

- A. Reusable-cup use increased during the trial
- B. Staff washing time increased
- C. Discounts always make every customer choose reusable products
- D. The cafe plans another test

Cooling Paint Tests

Text 2

Researchers painted small roof panels with three light-colored coatings and placed them beside an unpainted dark panel. On clear afternoons, all three coated panels stayed cooler than the dark panel. One coating remained cooler after several weeks of rain, while another began to crack. The researchers said durability should be considered along with cooling performance.

3. Which conclusion is best supported?

- A. All coatings perform identically over time
- B. Reflective coatings can reduce surface heat, but long-term usefulness also depends on durability
- C. Dark roofs are always unsafe
- D. Rain makes every coating stronger

4. Which generalization is supported?

- A. A product should be judged only by its first-day performance
- B. When evaluating a solution, more than one performance factor may matter
- C. The cheapest coating is always best
- D. All outdoor materials crack in rain

Reminder Cards

Text 3

A volunteer center placed reminder cards beside three tasks that were often done incorrectly. Errors fell for the two tasks with short, specific instructions. For the third task, the card contained a full paragraph and errors changed very little. Staff later replaced the paragraph with three short steps, and errors then decreased.

5. Which conclusion is best supported?

- A. Any reminder card will eliminate errors
- B. Short, clear instructions were more useful than a dense paragraph in this setting
- C. Volunteers cannot read paragraphs
- D. The third task was unnecessary

6. Which new situation best illustrates the same principle?

- A. A lab replaces a long equipment note with three visible safety steps and mistakes decrease
- B. A bookstore changes its wall color
- C. A cafeteria adds more chairs
- D. A student buys a thicker notebook

Review your reasoning

Before checking the key, mark the question that felt hardest. Write one clue that changed your mind and name the distractor that was most tempting.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A - The passage shows both reduced disposable-cup waste and increased washing work.

Watch for: A good conclusion keeps important benefits and tradeoffs together.

2. C - The passage describes one cafe trial, not a universal rule about all customers.

Watch for: Watch for absolute words such as always and every.

3. B - The results combine cooling performance with different durability outcomes.

Watch for: Use the final interpretation when it synthesizes multiple results.

4. B - The passage shows that cooling and durability both matter to evaluation.

Watch for: Transfer the principle, not the roof-paint topic.

5. B - The pattern compares specific short reminders with a dense paragraph and the revised short version.

Watch for: Do not turn a local pattern into an insult or universal claim.

6. A - The new situation uses the same principle: concise procedural guidance can be easier to follow.

Watch for: Match the relationship, not merely the word "card."